

D719

Student Teaching I in Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

Method © 2026 Erik Daniel Lindquist — Course Mastery Coach, armored drill. Items drafted with AI assistance under his direction.

How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A student with autism greets his special education teacher every morning in the resource room but never greets other adults. He enjoys trains and has a new pair of glasses. What should the student teacher plan next?

- A. Keep practicing only with the same teacher.
- B. Use a train picture as a greeting prompt.
- C. Practice greetings with different adults in different places, such as the office and cafeteria.
- D. Mark the goal mastered.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student mastered adding money in October, but in March she cannot do it. What was missing from the plan?

- A. Generalization across settings.
- B. Maintenance — planned review over time.
- C. Nothing; forgetting cannot be prevented.
- D. A harder goal in October.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A student teacher is teaching a student with a significant disability to name ten sight words. The student often guesses wrong and gets upset. The words are printed on large blue cards, and the lessons are after lunch. What procedure would reduce errors from the start?

- A. Constant time delay: prompt the word right away at first, then wait a few seconds before prompting.
- B. Wait until he is ready to try alone.
- C. Let him guess first, then correct errors.
- D. Print the cards in a different color.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A teacher using constant time delay has finished the 0-second rounds. What comes next?

- A.** Stop prompting completely.
- B.** Keep 0-second delay forever.
- C.** Increase the delay by one second each trial.
- D.** Insert a fixed delay, such as 4 seconds, before giving the prompt.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A student teacher is teaching a student to raise his hand for help. She praises every hand raise in the first week, and now he does it reliably. The class moved to a portable building, and his aunt is visiting. How should she adjust reinforcement?

- A.** Stop praising completely now.
- B.** Praise more because the room changed.
- C.** Keep praising every hand raise forever.
- D.** Shift to intermittent reinforcement, praising some hand raises.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student teacher wants to teach a completely new behavior. Which reinforcement schedule should she start with?

- A.** No reinforcement until the behavior is perfect.
- B.** Continuous reinforcement.
- C.** Intermittent reinforcement.
- D.** Punishment for not doing it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

A twelve-year-old with emotional disabilities starts yelling and pacing after losing a game. Classmates are watching, and it is the last period on a Friday before a holiday. What should the student teacher do first?

- A. Explain in detail why his behavior is wrong.
- B. Tell him the holiday will be canceled.
- C. Demand in a loud voice that he sit down now.
- D. Use a calm, quiet voice, give space, say few words, and offer a simple choice like a walk or a calm seat.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8.

A student teacher is preparing a conference for the family of a third grader who speaks Vietnamese at home. The student's older sister, age 14, is bilingual and eager to help. The school has a new parent center. What should the student teacher do?

- A. Hold the meeting in the parent center without an interpreter.
- B. Ask the sister to interpret.
- C. Arrange a trained interpreter and speak directly to the parents during the meeting.
- D. Hold the meeting in English and send notes later.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A four-year-old in an early childhood special education class has few spoken words. Her parents worry that a picture-based device will stop her from learning to talk. The class has a sensory corner, and she loves puppets. What is the best response?

- A. Explain that AAC does not stop speech and often supports it, and model the device during daily activities.
- B. Wait until she speaks more before using AAC.
- C. Use AAC only in the sensory corner.
- D. Tell parents AAC always replaces speech.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student teacher introduces a speech device to a student but only uses it when the student is asked a question. What is missing?

- A.** Adults modeling the device in daily talk.
- B.** Fewer uses so the student is not overwhelmed.
- C.** A harder device.
- D.** A test to prove readiness.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11.

A reading intervention for a student was scheduled for 30 minutes, five days a week. Data after six weeks are flat. The log shows it was delivered about twice a week, often for 15 minutes. The student recently joined the chess club. What should the team conclude?

- A.** The intervention does not work; switch it.
- B.** Deliver it as designed before judging it; the data cannot show whether it works.
- C.** The student needs a special class.
- D.** The chess club is taking his focus.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A student with ADHD in a hybrid program has trouble focusing during long live video calls but does well rewatching short lessons at his own pace. His family has one laptop and a dog. Which plan best fits his needs?

- A.** Buy the family another laptop.
- B.** Only asynchronous work with no live contact.
- C.** Use short asynchronous lessons he can replay, plus brief live check-ins for feedback.
- D.** Only live video calls, since they are always better.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer C Concept 1

A student with autism greets his special education teacher every morning in the resource room but never greets other adults. ~~He enjoys trains and has a new pair of glasses.~~ What should the student teacher plan next?

Target word: next step after one-setting mastery **Decides:** The skill appears with one person in one place.

A	Dropped element	Drops the new people and settings.
B	Camouflage	Answers the interest detail; does not address transfer.
C	Correct	Generalization needs varied people and settings.
D	Absolute language	Mastery in one setting is not generalization.

2. Answer B Concept 1 • transfer

A student mastered adding money in October, but in March she cannot do it. What was missing from the plan?

Target word: reverse: loss over time **Decides:** Skill was not kept up.

A	Confusion set	The problem is time, not setting.
B	Correct	Skills need scheduled practice after mastery.
C	Absolute language	Planned review reduces loss.
D	Inverted operation	Raising difficulty does not keep a skill.

3. Answer A Concept 2

A student teacher is teaching a student with a significant disability to name ten sight words. The student often guesses wrong and gets upset. ~~The words are printed on large blue cards, and the lessons are after lunch.~~ What procedure would reduce errors from the start?

Target word: errorless method **Decides:** Frequent errors cause frustration.

A	Correct	A 0-second delay prevents errors, and the later delay lets the student answer independently.
B	Adjacent category	Readiness waiting is not an instructional procedure.
C	Inverted operation	Builds errors before prompting.
D	Camouflage	Answers the card detail.

4. Answer D Concept 2 • transfer

A teacher using constant time delay has finished the 0-second rounds. What comes next?

Target word: reverse: next phase **Decides:** Insert a fixed delay.

A	Absolute language	Prompts still follow if the student does not respond.
B	Inverted operation	The student never gets a chance to answer alone.
C	Confusion set	That is progressive time delay, a different procedure.
D	Correct	This lets the student respond before the prompt.

5. Answer D Concept 3

A student teacher is teaching a student to raise his hand for help. She praises every hand raise in the first week, and now he does it reliably. ~~The class moved to a portable building, and his aunt is visiting.~~ How should she adjust reinforcement?

Target word: schedule after acquisition **Decides:** Behavior is now established.

A	Absolute language	Abrupt removal risks losing the behavior.
B	Camouflage	Answers the portable detail.
C	Inverted operation	Continuous forever makes the behavior fragile if praise stops.
D	Correct	Intermittent schedules maintain behavior and resist extinction.

6. Answer B Concept 3 · transfer

A student teacher wants to teach a completely new behavior. Which reinforcement schedule should she start with?

Target word: reverse: schedule for a new behavior **Decides:** Acquisition phase.

A	Absolute language	Waiting for perfection delays learning.
B	Correct	Reinforcing every correct response speeds learning.
C	Inverted operation	Better for maintaining, not teaching new behavior.
D	Adjacent category	Punishment does not teach the new behavior.

7. Answer D Concept 4

A twelve-year-old with emotional disabilities starts yelling and pacing after losing a game. Classmates are watching, and ~~it is the last period on a Friday before a holiday.~~ What should the student teacher do first?

Target word: de-escalation step **Decides:** Student escalating with an audience.

A	Dropped element	Too many words while he is upset.
B	Camouflage	Answers the holiday detail with an empty threat.
C	Inverted operation	Raises tension and invites a power struggle.
D	Correct	Calm, brief, space-giving responses lower escalation.

8. Answer C Concept 5

A student teacher is preparing a conference for the family of a third grader who speaks Vietnamese at home. The student's older sister, age 14, is bilingual and eager to help. ~~The school has a new parent center.~~ What should the student teacher do?

Target word: interpreting for a family **Decides:** Use a trained interpreter, not a child.

A	Camouflage	Answers the room detail.
B	Adjacent category	A child should not carry adult information or interpret for family meetings.
C	Correct	Qualified interpreters ensure accurate, private communication.
D	Dropped element	Drops meaningful participation.

9. Answer A Concept 6

A four-year-old in an early childhood special education class has few spoken words. Her parents worry that a picture-based device will stop her from learning to talk. ~~The class has a sensory corner, and she loves puppets.~~ What is the best response?

Target word: AAC concern **Decides:** Evidence shows AAC does not block speech.

A	Correct	Presume competence; AAC supports communication and speech.
B	Inverted operation	Waiting delays communication.
C	Camouflage	Answers the corner detail; AAC should be used across settings.
D	Absolute language	False; it does not replace speech.

10. Answer A Concept 6 · transfer

A student teacher introduces a speech device to a student but only uses it when the student is asked a question. What is missing?

Target word: reverse: what AAC teaching needs **Decides:** Modeling.

A	Correct	Students learn AAC by seeing it used, as children learn speech by hearing it.
B	Inverted operation	Less exposure slows learning.
C	Adjacent category	Device complexity is not the issue.
D	Dropped element	No readiness test is needed.

11. Answer B Concept 7

A reading intervention for a student was scheduled for 30 minutes, five days a week. Data after six weeks are flat. The log shows it was delivered about twice a week, often for 15 minutes. ~~The student recently joined the chess club.~~ What should the team conclude?

Target word: judging an intervention **Decides:** It was not delivered as designed.

A	Dropped element	Drops the fidelity check.
B	Correct	Fidelity must be checked before deciding an intervention failed.
C	Adjacent category	Placement changes are not justified by poorly delivered data.
D	Camouflage	Answers the club detail.

12. Answer C Concept 8

A student with ADHD in a hybrid program has trouble focusing during long live video calls but does well rewatching short lessons at his own pace. ~~His family has one laptop and a dog.~~ Which plan best fits his needs?

Target word: online mode choice **Decides:** He benefits from self-paced short content.

A	Camouflage	Answers the device detail, not the instructional mode.
B	Dropped element	Drops feedback and interaction.
C	Correct	Matches mode to his needs while keeping interaction.
D	Absolute language	No mode is always better.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	6	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	8	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	7	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	2	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Generalization and maintenance	A skill is not mastered until the student uses it across settings, people, and materials and keeps it over time; plan for this from the start.	Assuming mastery in one setting with one teacher means the skill transfers.	A skill shown only in the resource room or only with one adult.
2	Constant time delay	Start with a 0-second delay (prompt right after the cue) so the student makes no errors, then insert a fixed delay so the student can answer before the prompt.	Letting the student guess and fail first, then prompting.	A new skill where errors are frequent and discouraging.
3	Reinforcement schedules	Use continuous reinforcement to teach a new behavior and shift to intermittent reinforcement to maintain it and resist extinction.	Keeping continuous reinforcement forever, or starting with intermittent for a brand-new skill.	Whether a behavior is new or already established.
4	De-escalation	With an agitated student, stay calm, lower your voice, give space, use few words, and offer simple choices; avoid power struggles and audiences.	Raising your voice, demanding compliance, or arguing in front of peers.	A student who is getting louder and more upset.
5	Working with interpreters	Use a trained interpreter for family meetings, speak directly to the family, and never rely on the child or siblings to interpret.	Having the student translate because it is convenient.	A family who speaks a language other than English.
6	AAC and presuming competence	Augmentative and alternative communication should be offered early and modeled, presuming the student can learn; AAC does not stop speech from developing.	Waiting for “readiness” or fearing AAC will keep a child from talking.	A student with limited speech.
7	Implementation fidelity	Before deciding an intervention does not work, check that it was delivered as designed (right steps, dose, and frequency).	Dropping an intervention after poor data without checking how it was delivered.	Weak results from an intervention that was run irregularly.
8	Synchronous vs. asynchronous online learning	Synchronous sessions allow live interaction and immediate feedback; asynchronous work allows flexible pacing and repeat viewing — choose by the student’s needs and the learning goal.	Assuming one mode is always better for students with disabilities.	A remote or hybrid plan for a student with specific needs.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching I is the first part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. This course provides a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate and reflect upon professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies rooted in students' learning and

developmental patterns. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Advanced Clinical, candidates will receive ongoing feedback through observations and evaluations. Feedback will encourage candidates to reflect on their commitment to professional practices as educators, analyze and adjust teaching methods, and explore new teaching materials and methods that are culturally relevant. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into communication and collaboration, accepting feedback, creating positive learning environments, and technology and online learning. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.